

Daily Current Affairs Notes

Compiled from the September 11, 2026 Live Session — Current Affairs by Prachi

1. BRICS Summit – 18th Edition (New Delhi)

- India is hosting the **18th BRICS Summit** in New Delhi (12–13 September) at **Bharat Mandapam**; Delhi has a 3-day public holiday around the event.
- Origin:** Term 'BRIC' coined by Jim O'Neill in 2001; first summit held in Russia in 2009; South Africa joined in 2010 (making it 'BRICS').
- Original 5 members:** Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa.
- New members (joined 2024):** Egypt, Ethiopia, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Iran → group now called '**BRICS Plus**'.
- Newest member (2025–26):** Indonesia.
- India has hosted BRICS 3 times before: **2012 (Delhi)**, **2016 (Goa)**, and a **virtual summit during COVID**. This 2026 Delhi summit is the 4th time overall, but the **18th edition** globally.
- 17th Summit (previous edition) was held in **Brazil**.
- Theme of the 18th Summit:** "Building resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability."
- Russian President **Vladimir Putin** has already arrived; his **IL-76 military aircraft** was landed at **Jewar Airport, Noida** in advance for security purposes.
- Chinese President **Xi Jinping** is also attending — his first India visit since 2019 (Mahabalipuram, Tamil Nadu); relations had strained after the 2020 **Galwan Valley** clash in Ladakh.

2. China – Quick Geography Facts

- Capital: **Beijing** (old name: Peking).
- Best university in Asia: **Peking University**.
- Yangtze River** — city of **Shanghai** is located on its banks.
- Yellow River (Huang He)** — known as the 'Sorrow of China'.
- Taklamakan Desert** is located in China (west/northwest region).
- Mongolia** lies just north of this desert region; **Gobi Desert** (a cold desert) is also nearby.
- Hong Kong and Taiwan are located toward the south/southeast of the mainland map.
- Note: China's official map shows disputed 'stars' — can be asked in miscellaneous-type questions.

3. Exercise Yudh Abhyas (India–USA) – 22nd Edition

- Yudh Abhyas** is a joint **military (Army) exercise** between India and the USA; this is its **22nd edition**.
- Conducted in **two phases**: Phase 1 at **Bikaner (Mahajan Field Firing Range), Rajasthan**; Phase 2 at **Auli, Uttarakhand** (about 95 km from the LAC bordering China).
- Duration: **9 September to 28 September 2026**.
- Participating equipment: **Apache and Chinook helicopters** (both procured from the USA) and the **Pinaka** multi-barrel rocket launcher. Rafale and Tejas are NOT part of this exercise.
- First started in the year **2004**.
- Previous (21st) edition was held in **Alaska, USA**; the 20th edition was held in **Rajasthan**.

4. Other India Bilateral/Multilateral Military Exercises

- Indra** – with **Russia**
- JIMEX** – with **Japan**
- With **USA**: Tiger Triumph, Tiger Claw, Vajra Prahar, Red Flag, Cope India
- With **France**: Garuda, Varuna, Shakti
- Austra Hind** – with **Australia**
- Samudra Shakti** – with **Indonesia**
- Aerial exercise (air-to-air) – with **UK**
- Freedom Shield 2025** – joint exercise of **USA, Japan and South Korea**

- **Maitree** – with **Thailand**

5. Ladakh – New Article 371(K)

- Ministry of Home Affairs has proposed adding a **new chapter/clause 'K'** under **Article 371** of the Constitution, specifically for **Ladakh**.
- Article 371 (and its sub-clauses A, B, C...) provides **special rights** to certain States/UTs, e.g. 371A (Nagaland), 371B (Assam), 371C (Manipur), 371F (Sikkim).
- Ladakh became a **Union Territory on 31 October 2019**. It is administered by an **LG (Lieutenant Governor)** who is regulated by the **President**; the **Home Ministry** takes key decisions for UTs.
- Activist **Sonam Wangchuk** has been demanding inclusion of Ladakh under the **Sixth Schedule** (which grants Autonomous District Councils, as enjoyed by Assam, Tripura, Mizoram, Meghalaya – remembered by the acronym **ATM+M**). Ladakh is NOT yet included in the Sixth Schedule.
- Under the proposed **Article 371K**, Ladakh would get special rights similar to a State Legislative Assembly — control over land rights, forest rights, law-making, and use of natural resources — providing **additional protection**.
- This is separate from **Article 240**, which gives the **President power to make regulations for Union Territories**. Article 371K and Article 240 are distinct provisions and should not be confused.

Ladakh – Geography Notes

- Ladakh has **7 districts** now (originally only Leh and Kargil; 5 more were added later); capital is **Leh**.
- Located between the **Karakoram Range** (north) and the **Zaskar Range** (south).
- Key features: **Nubra Valley, Galwan Valley, Hemis National Park**.
- Known as a '**Cold Desert**'; famous for hills and the **Snow Leopard**; local language is **Ladakhi**; famous desert – **Nubra Desert**.
- Famous lakes: **Pangong Tso and Tso Moriri**.
- Rivers: **Indus, Nubra, Galwan, and Shyok**.

6. Awards & Honours

- **Rani Mukerji** conferred the **Raj Kapoor Award** (62nd edition) by the Maharashtra Government (CM **Devendra Fadnis**) at **Ravindra Natya Mandir, Mumbai**, for contribution to the film industry.
- At the 71st National Film Awards: Best Actress – **Rani Mukerji**; Best Actor (jointly) – **Shah Rukh Khan and Vikrant Massey**. (The upcoming 72nd National Film Awards will be held in **Gujarat**.)
- **Lifetime Achievement Award** at the same Maharashtra event given to veteran writer **Salim Khan**.
- **Miss World** title winner is from the **Dominican Republic**.
- **Miss Universe India** title won by **Kaajia**, from **Kerala**; she will represent India at Miss Universe in **Puerto Rico**.
- **Sarala Award** to be given to **Ashutosh Parida** by **OSSA**.
- **Lokmanya Tilak Award** given to **Ajit Doval** in **Pune** (by Maharashtra).

7. Orangutans Found in Odisha

- Five small/baby orangutans were unexpectedly found in the **Balasore forest, Odisha** in **September 2026** — orangutans are NOT naturally found in India, suspected to be linked to **illegal wildlife smuggling** (their value runs into lakhs/crores; sometimes kept as exotic pets).
- Orangutans are naturally found in **Indonesia, Malaysia, and Borneo** and belong to the '**Ape**' category (not monkeys).
- Three species of orangutan, all **Critically Endangered** (IUCN): **Bornean** (Borneo), **Sumatran** (Indonesia), and **Tapanuli** (Indonesia/Malaysia region).
- Baby orangutans typically stay with their mother for 5–6 months, reinforcing the smuggling theory since no mother was found with them.
- Related UPSC 2023 PYQ: an animal that uses a stick/twig tool to extract insects from tree holes — Answer: **Orangutan**.

Other Odisha Notes

- **Olive Ridley turtles, Irrawaddy dolphins**, and all **5 species of crocodiles** (Gharial in low numbers) are found in Odisha.
- **Chilika Lake** – Asia's largest lagoon lake.
- **Bali Yatra Festival** is celebrated at **Cuttack**, commemorating ancient sea voyages to Bali.

8. Appointments

- **Vinay Prakash Singh** reappointed as **Secretary General of the Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU)** for a **second (4-year) term**; announcement made in **Bangkok, Thailand**.
- APPU was formed in **1961**; headquartered in **Manila, Philippines**; has **32 member countries**.
- **Jitendra Mishra** appointed to the **Ram Mandir Trust**.

Thailand – Quick Facts

- Capital: **Bangkok**; Currency: **Baht**; located in **Southeast Asia**; river: **Mekong**; known for rubber production and White Elephants.

9. Dedicated Freight Corridors (DFC)

- **Western DFC** inaugurated by PM Modi: runs from **Dadri (Uttar Pradesh)** through **Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat** to **Jawaharlal Nehru Port (Nhava Sheva), Maharashtra**; length $\approx$ **1,506 km**.
- **Eastern DFC**: runs from **Ludhiana (Punjab)** to **Sonnagar, Bihar**; length $\approx$ **1,337 km**.

10. Ocean Research Vessel (ORV) & Mizoram HIV-Free District

- An **Ocean Research Vessel (ORV)**, Yard No. **341**, launched at **Kolkata** under the **Sagar Manthan** scheme; built by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)**, a **Navratna** company. It will be used for ocean surveillance and search operations.
- **Saitual district, Mizoram** has become the **first/only district in India** to achieve a '**zero HIV transmission**' status.

11. Sports

Duleep Trophy (Cricket) 2026-27

- Winner: **East Zone** (won for the 3rd time, and after a gap of 13 years) — defeated **South Zone** in the final held at **Chepauk, Chennai**.
- Most successful team: **West Zone** (won **19 times**).
- Player of the Match: **Ishan Kishan**. Tournament sponsored by **BCCI** as part of domestic cricket.

Other Domestic Trophies

- **Ranji Trophy** – won by **Jammu & Kashmir**.
- **Vijay Hazare Trophy** – won by **Vidarbha**.

Asian Games 2026 (20th Edition) – Mascot Launch

- Mascot name: '**Hanuhon**' – red in colour, symbolising the energy/passion (enthusiasm) of athletes; word means '**flame**' in Japanese.
- 20th Asian Games to be held in **Nagoya, Aichi Prefecture, Japan**, starting **19 September 2026**.
- India hosted the Asian Games twice before: **1951 (Delhi)** and **1982 (Delhi)**.
- At the 2022 Asian Games (hosted by China), India finished **4th** in the medal tally.
- Other recent mascots (for comparison): FIFA World Cup – Maple, Clutch, Zayu; Winter Olympics – Bing Dwen Dwen era mascots Tina & Milo; Khelo India University Games (Rajasthan) – Khambhagarhi.

World Para Archery / Para Series

- **Sheetal Devi** (from Jammu & Kashmir) won the **Gold medal**, defeating a Kazakhstan opponent.
- **Sarita** won a **Bronze medal** in archery.

- Sheetal Devi's earlier achievements: **Bronze at Paris Paralympics; Gold at 2025 World Para Archery Championship; Gold at Asian Para Games.**
- In the Mixed Team event: **Harvinder and Bhavna** won **Bronze**, defeating China.

12. Quick Revision (Rapid Fire)

- Mission '**Trishna**' to be launched by **CNES** (French space agency, with ISRO).
- USA declared an **emergency in Hawaii** due to three back-to-back cyclones.
- '**Spectrum**' – a private rocket built by **Germany**.
- Russia developing a **bridge with North Korea**.
- India signed an **MoU with Sri Lanka** for **L-70 guns**.
- **Global Fintech Fest** inaugurated by PM Modi in **Mumbai**.
- **APJ Abdul Kalam Seva Award** given to **Kishore Makwana**.
- **Pickleball World Cup** – India finished in **4th place**.
- **Himalaya Diwas (Himalaya Day)** observed on **9 September**.

Practice MCQs – Based on Today's Current Affairs

Q1. Which edition of the BRICS Summit is being hosted by India in New Delhi in 2026?

- A) 16th B) 17th C) 18th D) 20th

Answer: C) 18th

Q2. Who coined the term 'BRIC' in 2001?

- A) Jim O'Neill B) Kofi Annan C) Narendra Modi D) Vladimir Putin

Answer: A) Jim O'Neill

Q3. Which country joined BRICS most recently (2025-26), taking the group beyond 'BRICS Plus'?

- A) Saudi Arabia B) Indonesia C) Egypt D) Iran

Answer: B) Indonesia

Q4. What is the theme of the 18th BRICS Summit?

- A) Peace and Prosperity B) Building resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability C) One Earth One Family D) Growth for All

Answer: B) Building resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability

Q5. Where is the 18th BRICS Summit being held in New Delhi?

- A) Pragati Maidan B) Bharat Mandapam C) Vigyan Bhawan D) Red Fort

Answer: B) Bharat Mandapam

Q6. The 22nd edition of Exercise 'Yudh Abhyas' (India-USA) is being held in Bikaner and which other location?

- A) Auli, Uttarakhand B) Leh, Ladakh C) Pune, Maharashtra D) Jaisalmer, Rajasthan

Answer: A) Auli, Uttarakhand

Q7. In which year did Exercise Yudh Abhyas first begin?

- A) 2000 B) 2002 C) 2004 D) 2008

Answer: C) 2004

Q8. Exercise 'Samudra Shakti' is conducted between India and which country?

- A) Indonesia B) Australia C) Thailand D) Japan

Answer: A) Indonesia

Q9. Exercise 'Maitree' is held between India and which country?

- A) Myanmar B) Thailand C) Vietnam D) Sri Lanka

Answer: B) Thailand

Q10. The proposed new Article 371(K) of the Indian Constitution relates to which region?

- A) Jammu & Kashmir B) Ladakh C) Sikkim D) Nagaland

Answer: B) Ladakh

Q11. Ladakh became a Union Territory in which year?

A) 2014 B) 2016 C) 2019 D) 2021

Answer: C) 2019

Q12. Which Schedule of the Constitution has activist Sonam Wangchuk demanded for Ladakh?

A) Fifth Schedule B) Sixth Schedule C) Seventh Schedule D) Ninth Schedule

Answer: B) Sixth Schedule

Q13. Article 240 of the Constitution empowers whom to make regulations for Union Territories?

A) Prime Minister B) Parliament C) President D) Lieutenant Governor

Answer: C) President

Q14. Who is the current Lieutenant Governor (LG) of Ladakh, as referenced in the session?

A) Manoj Sinha B) Vinay Kumar Saxena C) R.N. Ravi D) Anil Baijal

Answer: B) Vinay Kumar Saxena

Q15. The Raj Kapoor Award (62nd edition) was recently given to which actress?

A) Alia Bhatt B) Rani Mukerji C) Deepika Padukone D) Kareena Kapoor

Answer: B) Rani Mukerji

Q16. The Lifetime Achievement Award at the same Maharashtra ceremony was given to?

A) Javed Akhtar B) Salim Khan C) Gulzar D) Anupam Kher

Answer: B) Salim Khan

Q17. Miss Universe India was recently won by Kaajia, who belongs to which state?

A) Kerala B) Tamil Nadu C) Karnataka D) Odisha

Answer: A) Kerala

Q18. The Lokmanya Tilak Award was recently conferred upon whom, in Pune?

A) S. Jaishankar B) Ajit Doval C) Amit Shah D) Rajnath Singh

Answer: B) Ajit Doval

Q19. Orangutans recently found in Odisha were located in which forest/district?

A) Similipal B) Balasore C) Bhitarkanika D) Nabarangpur

Answer: B) Balasore

Q20. As per IUCN status, all three orangutan species (Bornean, Sumatran, Tapanuli) are classified as?

A) Vulnerable B) Near Threatened C) Endangered D) Critically Endangered

Answer: D) Critically Endangered

Q21. Which lake is known as the largest lagoon lake in Asia, located in Odisha?

A) Chilika Lake B) Pulicat Lake C) Vembanad Lake D) Wular Lake

Answer: A) Chilika Lake

Q22. Vinay Prakash Singh has been reappointed as Secretary General of which organisation?

A) Universal Postal Union B) Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU) C) International Telecommunication Union D) World Customs Organization

Answer: B) Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU)

Q23. The Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU) is headquartered in which city?

A) Bangkok B) Manila C) Jakarta D) Singapore

Answer: B) Manila

Q24. The Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC) starts from Dadri and ends at?

A) Mumbai Port B) Jawaharlal Nehru Port (Nhava Sheva) C) Kandla Port D) Mundra Port

Answer: B) Jawaharlal Nehru Port (Nhava Sheva)

Q25. The Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor connects Ludhiana (Punjab) to which location?

A) Sonnagar, Bihar B) Kolkata, West Bengal C) Varanasi, UP D) Patna, Bihar

Answer: A) Sonnagar, Bihar

Q26. The newly launched Ocean Research Vessel (ORV), Yard No. 341, was built by which company at Kolkata?

A) Mazagon Dock B) Cochin Shipyard C) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE) D) Hindustan Shipyard

Answer: C) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)

Q27. Which district of Mizoram has become India's first district to achieve zero HIV transmission status?

- A) Aizawl B) Saitual C) Champhai D) Lunglei

Answer: B) Saitual

Q28. The Duleep Trophy 2026-27 final was won by which zone, defeating South Zone?

- A) West Zone B) East Zone C) North Zone D) Central Zone

Answer: B) East Zone

Q29. Which team has won the Duleep Trophy the maximum number of times (19)?

- A) South Zone B) North Zone C) West Zone D) East Zone

Answer: C) West Zone

Q30. Who was adjudged Player of the Match in the Duleep Trophy 2026-27 final?

- A) Ishan Kishan B) Shubman Gill C) Rishabh Pant D) Yashasvi Jaiswal

Answer: A) Ishan Kishan

Q31. The Ranji Trophy was recently won by which team?

- A) Mumbai B) Jammu & Kashmir C) Saurashtra D) Vidarbha

Answer: B) Jammu & Kashmir

Q32. The Vijay Hazare Trophy was recently won by which team?

- A) Vidarbha B) Karnataka C) Tamil Nadu D) Delhi

Answer: A) Vidarbha

Q33. The official mascot of the 20th Asian Games (2026) is named?

- A) Miraitowa B) Hanuhon C) Bandhie D) Soohorang

Answer: B) Hanuhon

Q34. The 20th Asian Games will be hosted by which city/country?

- A) Nagoya, Japan B) Hangzhou, China C) Doha, Qatar D) Incheon, South Korea

Answer: A) Nagoya, Japan

Q35. The word 'Hanuhon' (Asian Games mascot name) means which of the following in Japanese?

- A) Wind B) Flame C) Victory D) Harmony

Answer: B) Flame

Q36. Where did India stand in the medal tally at the 2022 (19th) Asian Games hosted by China?

- A) 2nd B) 3rd C) 4th D) 5th

Answer: C) 4th

Q37. Sheetal Devi, who recently won gold at the World Para Archery event, belongs to which state/UT?

- A) Himachal Pradesh B) Jammu & Kashmir C) Punjab D) Uttarakhand

Answer: B) Jammu & Kashmir

Q38. In the Mixed Team Archery final, Harvinder and Bhavna won a Bronze medal by defeating which country?

- A) Kazakhstan B) China C) South Korea D) USA

Answer: B) China

Q39. Mission 'Trishna', recently announced for launch, is associated with which space agency (with ISRO)?

- A) NASA B) ESA C) CNES D) JAXA

Answer: C) CNES

Q40. The private rocket 'Spectrum', recently in the news, has been built by which country?

- A) Germany B) France C) UK D) Japan

Answer: A) Germany

Q41. 'Himalaya Diwas' is observed every year on which date?

- A) 5 September B) 9 September C) 14 September D) 21 September

Answer: B) 9 September

Q42. India recently signed an MoU with Sri Lanka regarding which defence equipment?

- A) L-70 guns B) BrahMos missiles C) Akash missile system D) Tejas aircraft

Answer: A) L-70 guns